

有好几个周六，我都在见朋友的路上，离开我家几步远看得到一个人扔掉的垃圾。这样扔掉垃圾是非法的，但几个月后这些人还没停。比如，去年我看到了一台在墙旁放着屏幕被打碎了非常宽大的电视机。一有不要的电子垃圾，就一定带它去回收中心——特别是因为这种垃圾有毒剂物质。

我觉得提高罚款不会让罪犯们害怕到不再在路上乱扔垃圾。相反，为了找到他们，地方议会要在常被乱扔的地方安装电子眼。找到那些会乱扔的人是地方议会的责任，不是警察的。但我不觉得地方议会会尝试找他们，因为只抓到一队罪犯不会把收入增加得可观。结果地方议会就选择了雇佣一家私人公司，用他们的“乱扔巡逻员”，让他们在马路上走来走去，帮地方议会处罚把小物品乱扔的人。一次，我在公共长椅坐着，一个巡逻员来了，告诉我因为我刚乱扔的烟，我需要把我的个人信息给他，让他做一张罚款——其实他尝试做那张罚款以前没有透露他打算处罚我。当时坐在我身边的朋友确定他说的话并不属实——我连烟都不抽。我学到了，对他们来说，惩办不重要乱扔的情况比惩办麻烦公众的情况有益，连虚构的都惩办比只惩办现实的更有益。

On Saturdays, when I'm on my way to see my friend, I sometimes happen to find some garbage which somebody had thrown out – just a few steps away from my house. Throwing out garbage like this is illegal, but after a couple months, those people still have not stopped. For example, last year I saw a very large TV, with a cracked screen, left lying against a wall. Once having acquired any undesirable e-waste, one must take it to the recycling centre – especially because this kind of waste contains toxic substances.

I feel that increasing the fines will not scare off criminals to the point that they will not litter again. Instead, in order to find them, the local council should install cameras to monitor areas which are frequent littering sites. It is the responsibility of the local council to find people who litter, not the police. But I don't think that the local council will try to look for them because arresting a single team of criminals will not significantly increase their revenue. As a result, the local council chose to contract a private company for their 'littering patrollers' to walk up and down the streets and serve the local council by fining people who litter small items. In the past, a patrolling officer came as I sat on a bench to tell me that, because of cigarette which I had just littered, I had to give him my information so he could make a fine - actually he did not reveal his intention to fine me before making the fine. My friend who was sitting next to me at the time was absolutely certain that what he said was not true since I don't even smoke. I have learned that, for them, it is more profitable to punish inconsequential cases of littering than it is to punish those which actually disrupt the public, and that it is even more profitable to punish imagined cases than real ones.